As noted, the city functions as both home and haunt for many, but for Americans, the resonances abound due to Cold War governance and culture: one still encounters a city with buildings, institutions, and streets bearing prominent American names in the former West, such as President John F. Kennedy, Henry Ford, John Foster Dulles, Lucius D. Clay, and Martin Luther King Jr., as figures of western freedom; on the former East side, names found in official and unofficial sites of inscription such as Paul Robeson, W. E. B. Du Bois, and Angela Davis ring out with a different resonance, to call attention to racial injustice within the United States and beyond.

In addition to these connections, an architectural topography that now includes trails and traces of the wall system runs throughout the reunified city. To this day, there are buildings still riddled with leftover bullet holes, rubble contained just beneath the surface, and in-situ burial grounds from World War II firefights. Beyond the divide between East and West, Berlin signifies as a twin city across historical eras: as a haunted, layered necropolis on one hand and a city of renewal and rebirth on the other. Communities of immigrants and refugees, including those resettled in the shuttered Tempelhof Airport, the site of the former Nazi air operations and later the U.S. airlift, add layers of intrigue to Germany's own rebuilding projects. In Berlin, one can still seek any number of questions about the nature of post–Cold War democracy, including those that deal with or strategically turn away from the iconic wall. This borderland geography of Berlin encompasses and expands well beyond the Wall's former footprint.

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A Wall of Our Own proposes a renewed call to collectively explore the work of American artists, writers, and activists in Berlin during the Cold War—in part, to make sense of the continued practice of identification with the Wall and other geopolitical discourses that remain vitally connected to Berlin. While an American presence in divided Berlin was originally personified through extensive military deployment and prominent political appearances along this volatile zone, American artists and writers mapped, read, and expanded significant aspects of Daum's notion of "America's Berlin," as a place of democratic longing and experimentation. Berlin continues to be a place where we reckon not only with German history but with American